

Argumentative Essay Writing

Argumentative Essay

The argumentative essay

is a genre of writing that requires you to:

1. Investigate a topic
2. Collect & Evaluate evidence
3. Establish a position on the topic in a very concise manner

Everyday Life Example

When we argue:

Ali: That was a lame movie!

Claim

Aleezy: Why?

Evidence

Ali: The special effects were bad. The monsters were obviously fake, the script was all too predictable and the music wasn't noteworthy.

Counterclaim

Aleezy: I thought the movie was good because the acting was believable.

Refutation

Ali's bad response: You are an idiot.

Ali's good response: Yes the acting was good but the horrible special effects were too distracting and caused some awkward moments.

Difference between Persuasive and Argumentative Essay

Persuasive

- Claims based on opinion
- May not take opposing views
- Emotion based

Argumentative

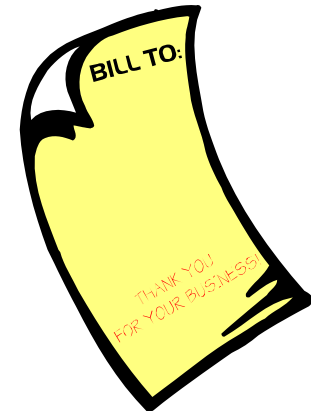
- Claims based on factual evidence (research)
- Opposing views
- Logic based

Elements of Argumentation

Argument/Claim

An **argument** states a **claim** and supports it with reasons and evidence from sources.

Arguing your side makes you the **proponent**.



Elements of Argumentation

Counterargument/Counterclaim

An argument that stands in opposition to your argument/claim. The counterargument is your **opponent's** (the other side's) argument that tries to explain why you are wrong.



Elements of Argumentation

Refutation

Simply disproving an opposing argument. It is an important skill because it is how a writer successfully convinces the audience of the validity of his/her own argument.



Methods for Constructing an Introduction

- personal anecdote
- question
- shocking statistics

Thesis Statement

Prompt: Should Schools have Dress Codes?

- First of all you should understand/decide your position:
- Pick one side
 1. What are the reasons why schools should have dress codes
 2. What are the reasons why schools should not have dress codes

Example of Thesis Statement:

Schools should have dress codes because peer pressure as a result of appearance decreases, students can focus on their studies rather than be distracted by revealing or inappropriate clothing, although some people believe students should express their individuality by wearing whatever they want at school.

Helpful phrases to acknowledge the opposition

- Although_____
- Despite the belief that,
- While some people believe_____
- Certainly some people feel _____

Topic

Should newspapers be printed anymore or not?

Online Thesis Builder: <https://www.kibin.com/>
<https://writingcenter.uagc.edu/thesis-generator>